

Q I want to buy a new PC. My total budget is Rs. 70,000. I already have an LCD TV and speakers, and so I don't need these. Is Quad Core required or will Core 2 Duo be more than sufficient? Which series in Core 2 Duo is good? I want to be able to add performance in the future. Which motherboard do you recommend? Should I go in for a full tower cabinet or a compact one? I don't wish to compromise on performance unless it is very marginal. Do I need a 1000 W power supply or will something smaller do? Remember, I want SLI or Crossfire in the future. Also, which ISP should I choose? I wish to have good download speeds. My budget for this is Rs. 300 per month, not more.

Anand Krishnan

A Hi, regarding the ISP, you will have to check locally, since tariffs differ. I have found Reliance's WiMAX service to be good. BSNL is also convenient for most, but your budget needs to be extended. Regarding your PC, unless you can go for a Core i7, remember that both SLI and Crossfire will not be possible on the same motherboard. I recommend a Core 2 Quad-based PC based on DDR2 RAM. I don't recommend either SLI or Crossfire; stick with a single card.

My PC configuration is Intel Core 2 Quad Q9550 (Rs. 15,500), ASUS P5Q motherboard (Rs. 8,500), 2 x 2 GB DDR2 800 MHz (Corsair) (Rs. 3,600), ZOTAC GeForce GTX 285 (Rs. 25,000). Buy a Corsair HX 620 or TX 650 PSU (Rs. 6,500). The Coolermaster 690 chassis (Rs. 4,500) should be suitable for this rig. You will spend Rs. 63,600 on these components.

Q I live in Nepal and want to buy a laptop. My budget is Rs. 70,000. It should have about 2 GB RAM, 160 GB hard disk and I also want to use it for light gaming. If I have to buy it from India, what will be the shipping cost and price in Nepalese currency.

Anish Dharmi



A I recommend the Dell Studio XPS 16 if size is not a constraint for you. Alternatively, if you want something compact the Studio XPS 13 is my suggestion. Both of these are available from Dell India, but I'm not sure about their availability in Nepal. You could try getting in touch with Dell's helplines in India. Both notebooks will fit within your budget and with shipping should come close to Rs. 70,000. Alternatively, try down New Road in Kathmandu.

Q I want to buy a good camera phone. I want something new and flashy looking. My budget is Rs. 10,000 to 13,000.

Vishal Singh

A I suggest Sony Ericsson's K850i, available for Rs. 14,000 on the street, although the MRP is much higher. It's got a great camera and is a good phone if you can live with the tiny keypad. It's also very compact. Else, Nokia's N73 Music Edition will be available for Rs. 12,000 or so, and while its camera is not as good, it's every

bit as good a phone and has good battery life.

Q Can you help me select a graphics card for mid-end gaming (FIFA'09 etc) within a budget of Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 7,000. Does it make any difference with respect to performance, compatibility and service between NVIDIA & ATI? Also, does it require a higher capacity power supply? I've the following existing configuration:

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E6420 2.13GH, RAM: 2GB

Jinesh Gandhi

A I recommend an NVIDIA GeForce 9600GT-based graphics card. Brands such as EVGA, Zotac, ASUS and Gigabyte are the best. You could also look a Palit, which may be a bit cheaper. All of these brands should have offerings priced below the Rs. 7,000 mark.

Q After scoring good in my boards, my father wants to gift me a mobile, after reading two to three of your magazines I ended up on Samsung L700. It fits best in our budget with a street price of Rs. 6,800. Is there any other option? My basic requirements is 3G, a good camera (best one I can get) with great looks. My budget is Rs. 6,000 to Rs. 8,000.

Varun Dhimian

A Since you want good features, I suggest hunting around for some of the older models in the market. Sony Ericsson's K750i (non 3G) and Nokia's 6630 are two great models that have become very cheap because they are old. However, their capabilities have not diminished in any way. You could also check out the Sony Ericsson K660 that has a good camera. All of these should be priced below the Rs. 8,000 mark. Out of the three, the Nokia

6630 has the most basic camera.

Q I live in Andaman and I'm a student. I want to buy a digicam with at least 7 MP. My budget is Rs. 8,000.

Rahul Bairagi

A I recommend Canon's A480 or the A590IS, although the latter may be a bit overpriced. Please remember to check the street prices instead of purchasing it from some mall or showroom, since the prices will be much lower.

Q I plan to upgrade my old PC for some future proofing and decent computing experience. My motherboard does not support a graphic card slot, has 512 MB of RAM and an Intel Celeron 2.0 GHz CPU. It would



be very kind of you if you could suggest some serious upgrades for my antique piece. I require it for smooth game play, for being able to play a few of the latest games like Prince of Persia 4, COD4, DMC-4, Spiderman 3, although not at highest detail levels. I have a total budget of Rs. 8,000. You may extend it by Rs. 2,000.

Piyush Mishra

A I recommend AMD 740G based motherboard. Brands to look at are Gigabyte, MSI and ASUS. Expect to pay around Rs. 3,500 for the motherboard. A GeForce 9400GT graphics card will set you back by Rs. 3000 more. AMD's X2 5400+ should cost you around Rs 3,000. Finally pick up 2 GB of DDR2 RAM for Rs 1,500. If you could extend your budget further, spend an additional Rs. 3,000 on the graphics card and pick up the GeForce 9600 GT - a sweet deal that will play all these games with some of the eye candy enabled.

